

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1032

By Pody

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Kehilla Upper School of Nashville.

WHEREAS, Kehilla Upper School of Nashville emerged in response to a longstanding gap in the Jewish educational system within the City of Nashville, where families historically had access to Jewish elementary education through Akiva School but lacked local options for upper-level Jewish day school education; and

WHEREAS, for many years, families seeking continued Jewish education beyond the sixth grade were often required to relocate to larger cities due to the prevailing assumption that a full upper-school program was not sustainable within a community of Nashville's size; and

WHEREAS, a group of educators and community leaders sought to address this need by establishing the Jewish Middle School of Nashville (JMS), representing an initial effort to extend Jewish education beyond the elementary level; and

WHEREAS, the success and growth of JMS demonstrated both community demand and program viability, ultimately leading to its expansion into a high school program now known as Kehilla Upper School; and

WHEREAS, Kehilla Upper School provides advanced Judaic and rabbinic studies while also welcoming students from diverse faith backgrounds, offering education grounded in Judeo-Christian values and including instruction in the Hebrew language; and

WHEREAS, the establishment of Kehilla Upper School created, for the first time in Nashville, a continuous local Jewish day school educational pathway from early childhood through secondary education; and

WHEREAS, the institution has developed a reputation for delivering rigorous college-preparatory academics alongside faith-based learning within a student-centered environment, including experiential learning opportunities, such as a senior-year trip to Israel; and

WHEREAS, Kehilla Upper School currently serves students in grades seven through twelve and provides a comprehensive educational experience that integrates intellectual development, personal identity, character formation, and civic responsibility; and

WHEREAS, the school has evolved into a significant institution within the Nashville community, contributing to the sustainability and growth of Jewish secondary education in the region; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Kehilla Upper School of Nashville for its significant contributions to education and community development and extend our best wishes for its continued success in the years to come.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.